

GitHub for Digital Humanities

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Step-by-step Instructions

Find the GitHub Repository and Documentation

Go to the github-for-dh repository online, <https://github.com/dominicfgentile-arch/github-for-dh>. Keep it open in your browser throughout the workshop. Use the README on the homepage for reference.

Install Git

Installing Git on Windows machines

Use the command line:

1. In Powershell copy this command `winget install --id Git.Git -e --source winget`
2. Paste it into Powershell using ctrl + C
3. Press enter
4. This will take you to a dialog box that will walk you through the installation.
5. Click through the installation without changing any of the options.

Use the GUI installer:

1. Navigate to <https://git-scm.com/install/windows>
2. Select “Click here to download” at the top of the page
3. This will take you to a dialog box that will walk you through the installation.
4. Click through the installation without changing any of the options.

Installing Git on Macs

1. In terminal type `xcode-select --install` + return
2. Paste it into Terminal using cmd + C
3. Press enter
4. This will take you to a dialog box that will walk you through the installation.
5. Click through the installation without changing any of the options.

In you are unable to install Git using this method please let us know!

Open the Command Line

Windows Users:

- Press the windows key (⊞) and enter "powershell" in the search bar + enter

Mac Users:

- Go to the Spotlight search bar and type "terminal" + return

Verify that You Have Git Installed

Type `git --version` into the command line. If you get an error message you do not have Git installed or typed the command incorrectly.

If you have Git installed your terminal should output something like this: `git version`
`2.55.0.windows.5`

Navigate to your Desktop Using `cd`

Type `pwd` + enter/return to determine where you are on your computer (aka your **current working directory**). Your terminal should output something like this: `/c/Users/<Username>`. This is called a **filepath**.

Your desktop is located here: `/c/Users/<Username>/desktop`. By adding `/desktop` we are telling the computer to move to your desktop folder which is located within `<Username>`.

To get to your desktop we use `cd <filepath>`. `cd` changes our **directory** from one file path to another.

Type `cd ~/desktop` + enter/return.

Test where you are using `pwd`.

List the Files on Your Desktop using `ls`

Type `ls` + enter/return after you have moved to your desktop to see all of your files and directories contained there.

Clone our GitHub Repository using `git clone <url>.git`

Type `clone git https://github.com/dominicfgentile-arch/github-for-dh.git` +
enter/return

Check to see the contents of this repository using `ls`

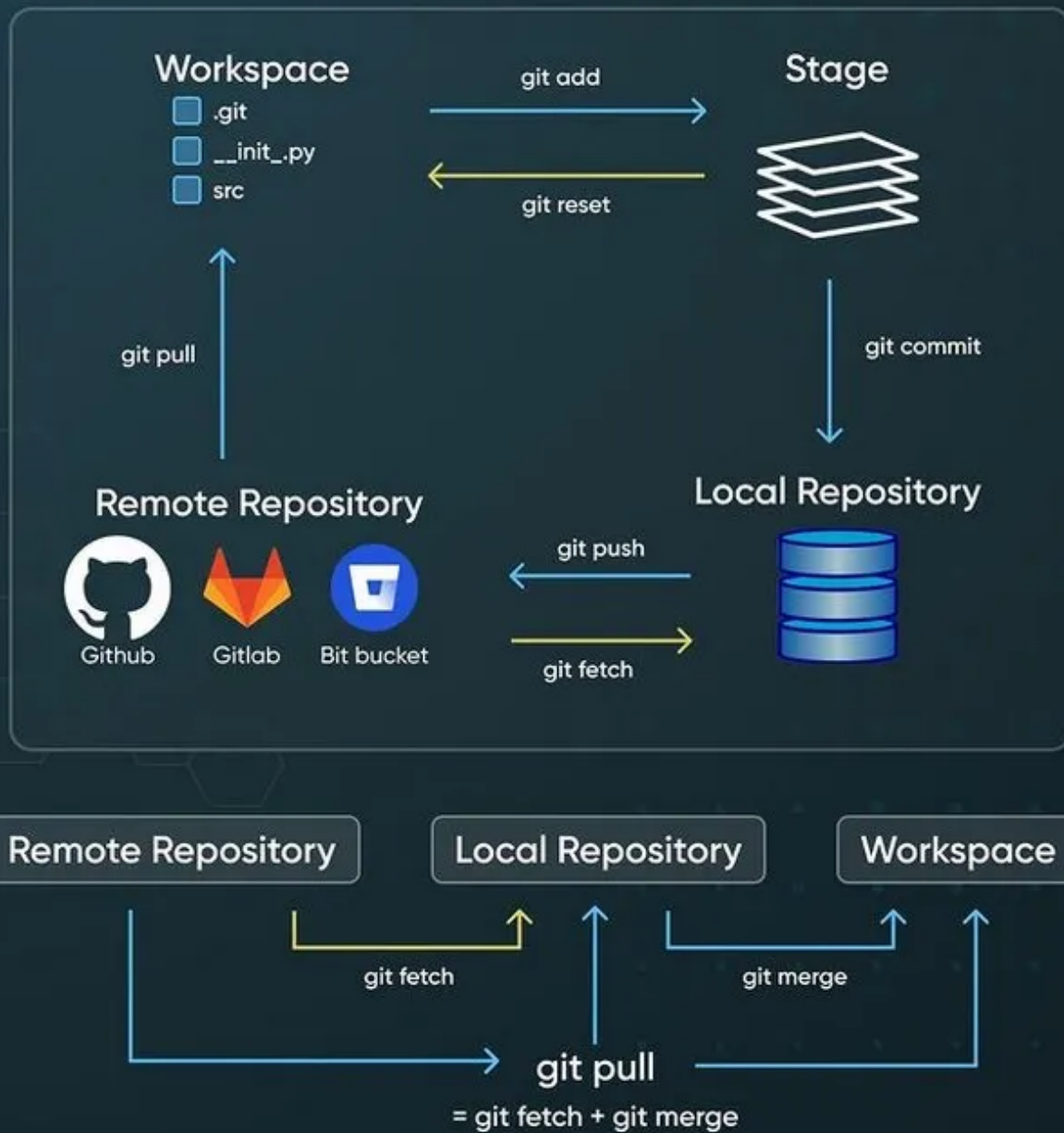
Command Line Reference

Git Commands

Process	Description
init	creates a new repository
clone .git	used to download a local copy of a remote repository. Use only once.
pull	used to update the local copy of the repository with changes (“commits”) that other users have made to the remote repository.
commit	logs the changes you made to your local repository
push	takes local changes (created, edited, deleted files) and adds them to the remote repository



How Git works



Powershell/Terminal Commands

Command	Description
cd	change current directory – change the folder in which your commands will work

Command	Description
	Use “cd ~” to navigate to your home directory And “cd ~/desktop” to navigate to your desktop
pwd	print working directory – prints out the filepath of the directory you are currently in
ls	lists the files and directories contained in your current working directory
git --version	Use to check to see if you have Git installed or which version of git you have
git --clone .git	Use to download a local copy of a remote repository. Use only once.
clear	Clears your terminal window.
ctrl + c (control + c)	Quits a process that is running.

Use `git clone` in place of `git fetch` the first time you download the remote repository

References

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Resources

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"Difference between terminal, console, shell, and command line." (2025, July 23). GeeksforGeeks. <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/operating-systems/difference-between-terminal-console-shell-and-command-line/>

“Git Cheat Sheet.” (n.d.). Git. Accessed September 20, 2026. <https://git-scm.com/cheat-sheet>

“GitHub Student Developer Pack.” GitHub. <https://education.github.com/pack>

- Microcredentials and short courses
- Access to learning modules and certifications that are usually paywalled
- Free access upon proof that you are a student

“Software Carpentry Lessons.” (2026). Software Carpentry. The Carpentries. <https://software-carpentry.org/lessons/>

- See ["The Unix Shell"](#) and ["Version control with Git"](#) lessons